Experiment - 08

Configuring User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in a Zoho Creator Application

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AIM

To configure user management and role-based access control (RBAC) in the Hotel Booking application in Zoho Creator, using permission sets, roles, a role hierarchy and data sharing, so that each user gets only the access needed for their work.

PROCEDURE

RBAC controls access by giving every user a role and a permission set. The permission set decides what the user can do with the components of the application, and the role decides which records the user can see through the role hierarchy. Figure 1 shows the model and Figure 2 shows the hierarchy planned for the Hotel Booking application.

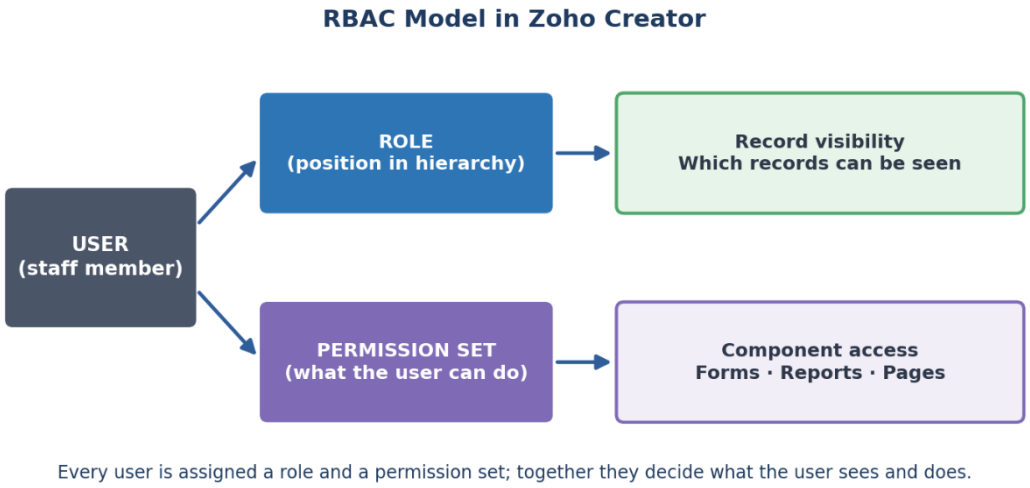


Figure 1: RBAC Model in Zoho Creator (Conceptual Diagram)



Figure 2: Role Hierarchy of the Hotel Booking Application (Conceptual Diagram)

The planned access of each role is summarised in Table 1.

Role	Hotel Booking Form	Bookings Report	Dashboard
CEO	Add, view, edit, delete	View all	View
Hotel Manager	Add, view, edit, delete	View all	View
Front-Desk Staff	Add, view, edit	View	No access
Housekeeping Supervisor	View only	View	No access

Table 1: Planned Access of Each Role

Phase A: Open User Permissions

1. Sign in to Zoho Creator and open the Hotel Booking application in Edit mode.
2. Click Settings and select User Permissions. The tabs Permissions, Roles and Data Sharing are displayed.

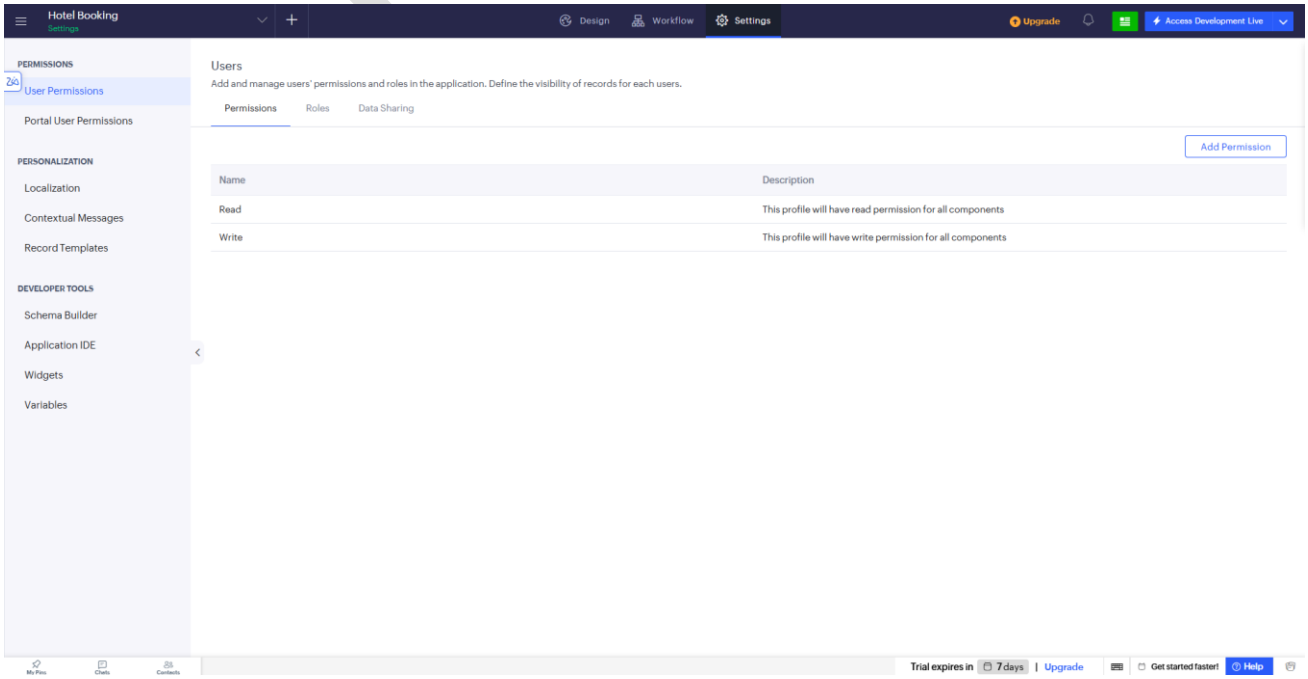


Figure 3: User Permissions Page of the Hotel Booking Application

Phase B: Review and Add Permission Sets

3. Open the Permissions tab. Two predefined permission sets are listed: Read, with read permission for all components, and Write, with write permission for all components.
4. Click Add Permission, enter a name such as Front Desk and a description, and select the components that this permission set may access, as in Table 1.
5. Save the permission set.

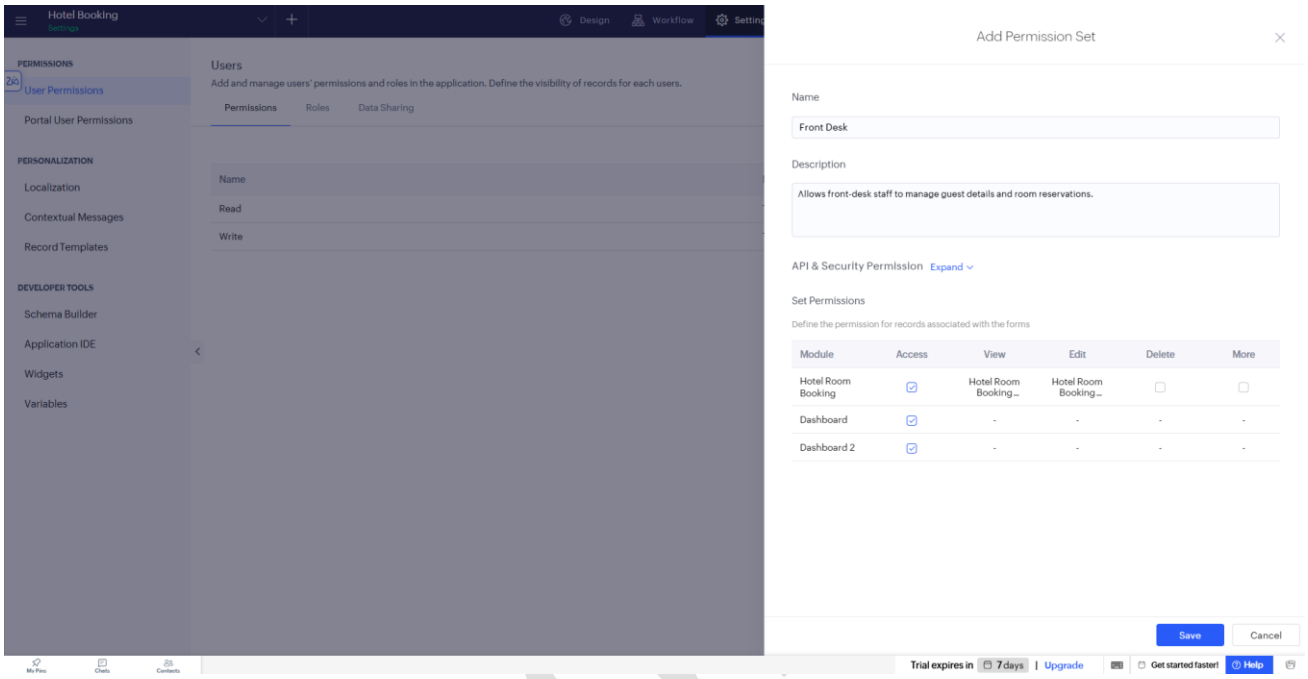


Figure 4: Permissions Tab with the Predefined and the New Permission Sets

Phase C: Create Roles

6. Open the Roles tab. The default role CEO is displayed with the options Expand All, Collapse All, Manage Role Hierarchy and Add Role.
7. Click Add Role and enter the details given in Table 2 for each role.
8. Save the role, then use Manage Role Hierarchy to check that the roles are arranged as in Figure 2.

Role Name	Reports To	Description
Hotel Manager	CEO	Manages hotel room reservations and staff
Front-Desk Staff	Hotel Manager	Creates and updates reservations
Housekeeping Supervisor	Hotel Manager	Views room and booking status

Table 2: Role Details (Share Data with Peers Not Selected)

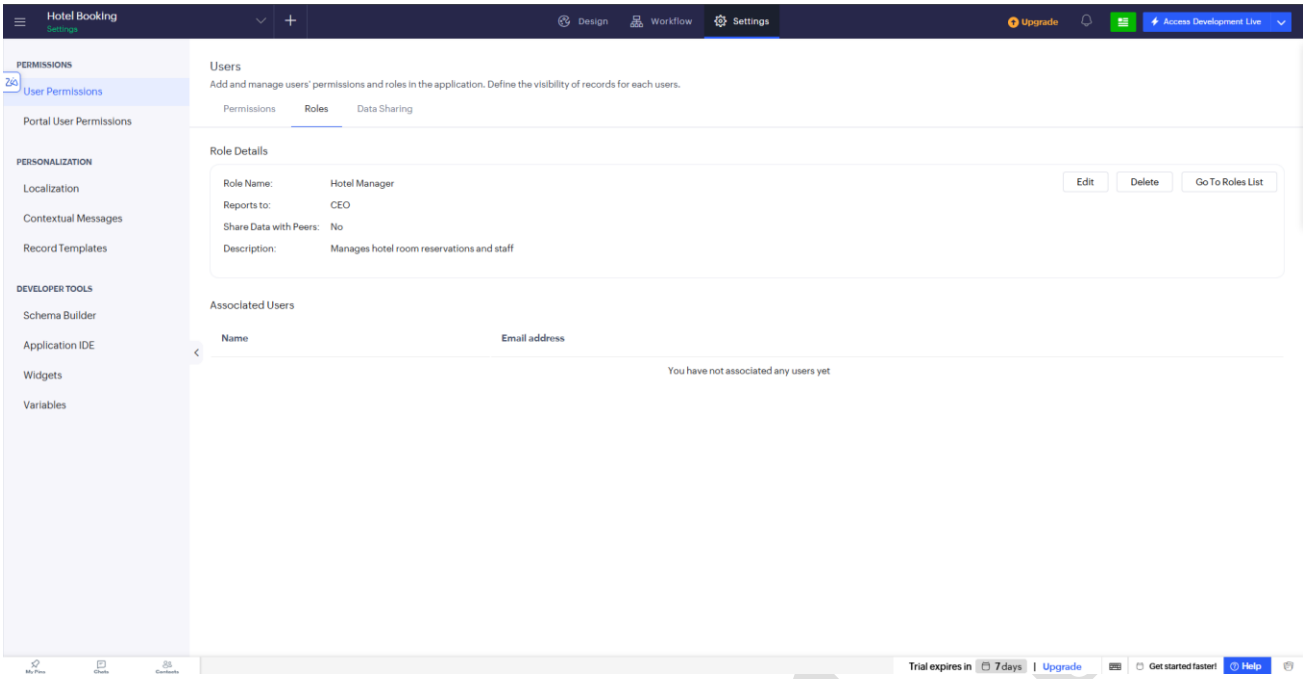


Figure 5: Roles Tab and Add Role Panel

Phase D: Add Users

9. Open the Users section of the account, or the invite option of the application.
10. Click Add User, enter the email address of the staff member and choose the Hotel Booking application.
11. Assign the permission set and the role to the user, for example Front Desk and Front-Desk Staff, and send the invitation.
12. Repeat for each staff member and check that every user appears in the Users list.

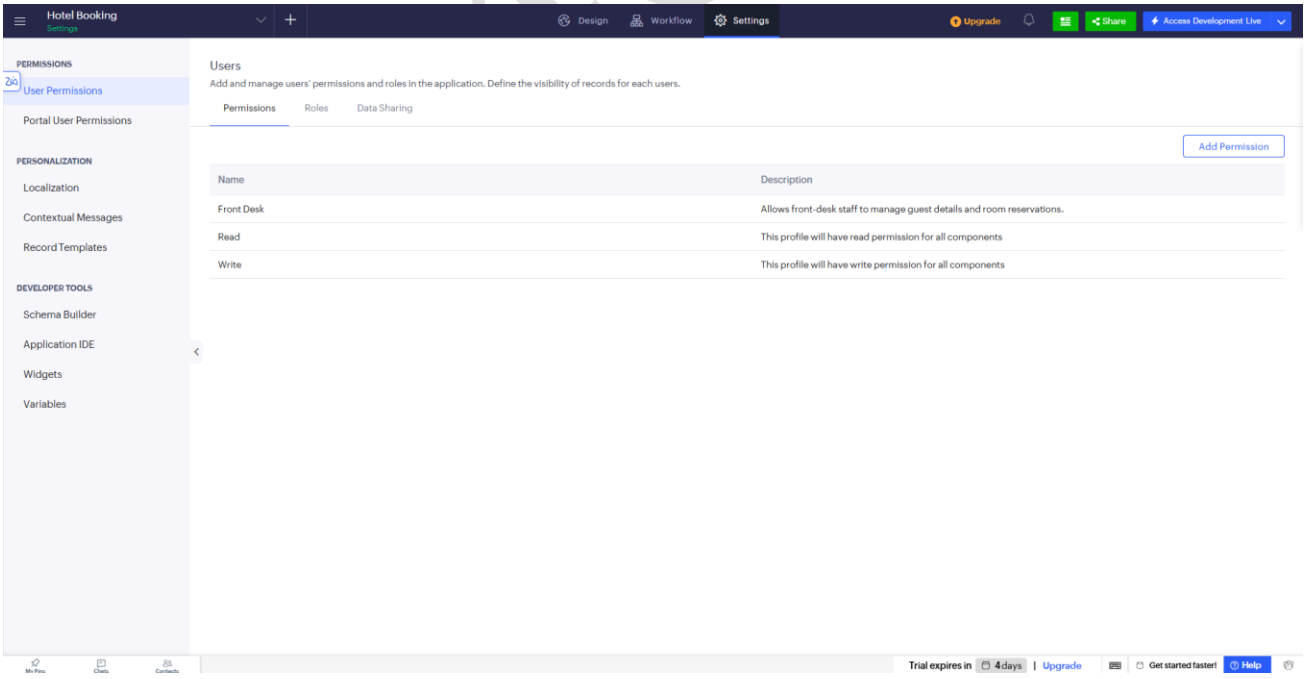


Figure 6: Users Added to the Hotel Booking Application with Their Roles

Phase E: Configure Data Sharing

13. Open the Data Sharing tab and click New Share Rule.
14. Enter the details given in Table 3 and save the rule.

Parameter	Value
Rule Name	Booking Data Sharing
Form	Hotel Room Booking
Shared From	Hotel Manager (role)
Shared To	Housekeeping Supervisor (role)
Access Level	Read

Table 3: Data Sharing Rule

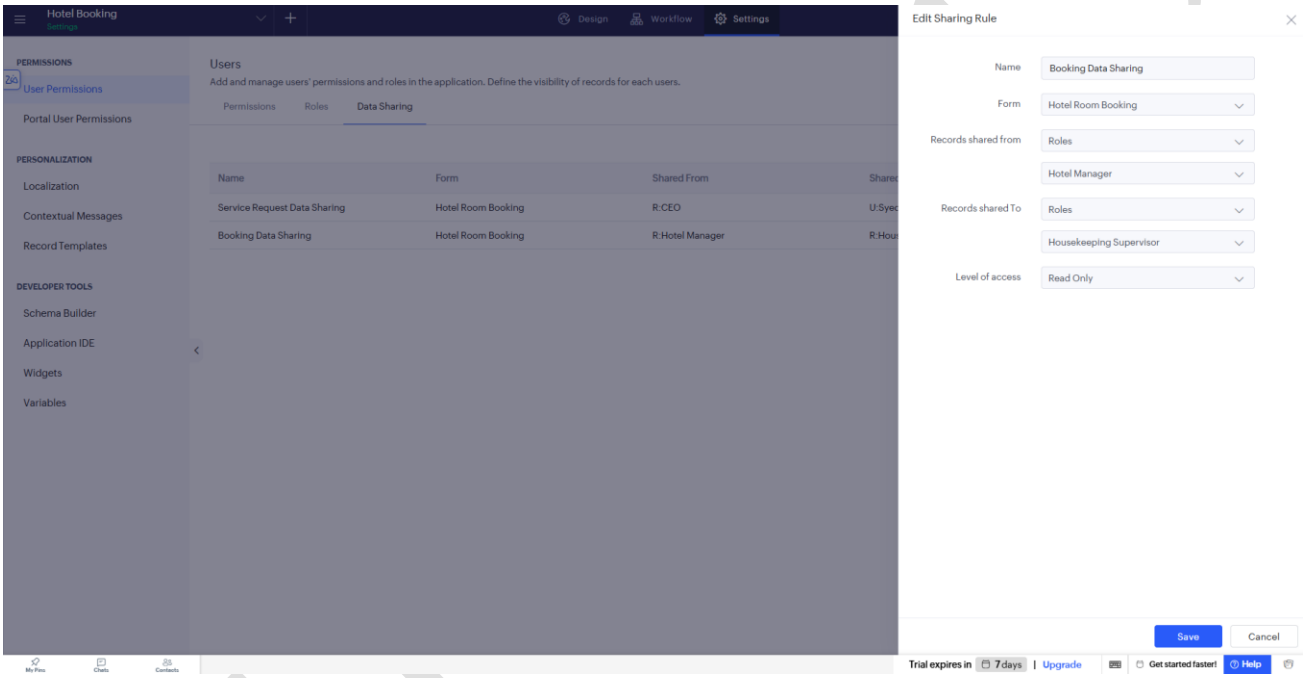


Figure 7: Data Sharing Rule for the Hotel Room Booking Form

Phase F: Test the Access Control

15. Sign in to the application with each user account, for example in a separate browser window.
16. Check which forms, reports and pages each user can see, and which actions are available.
17. Compare the result with Table 1 and correct the permission set or role if there is a difference.

Figure 8 summarises how the access of a user is decided during these tests.

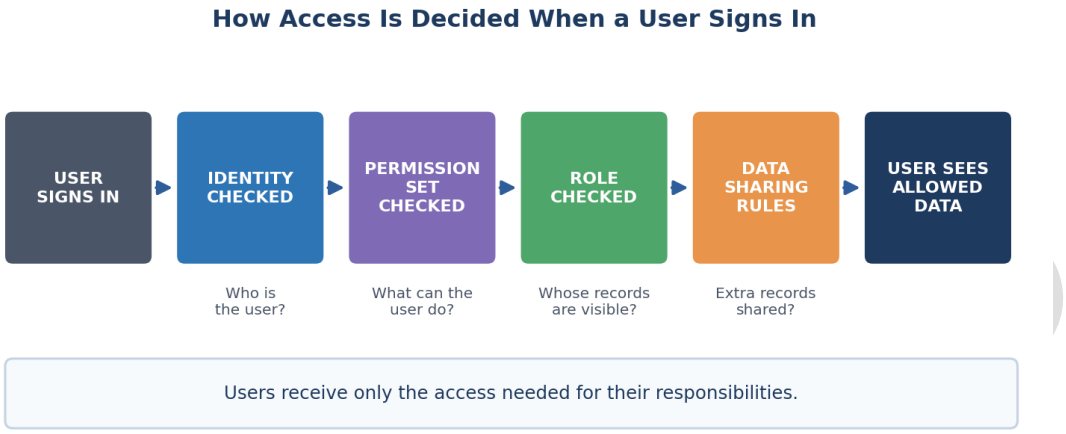


Figure 8: How Access Is Decided When a User Signs In (Conceptual Diagram)

Some options, such as saving custom roles or portal user permissions, may depend on the plan of the Zoho Creator account. Any option that is restricted by the plan should be noted as an observation.

OUTPUT

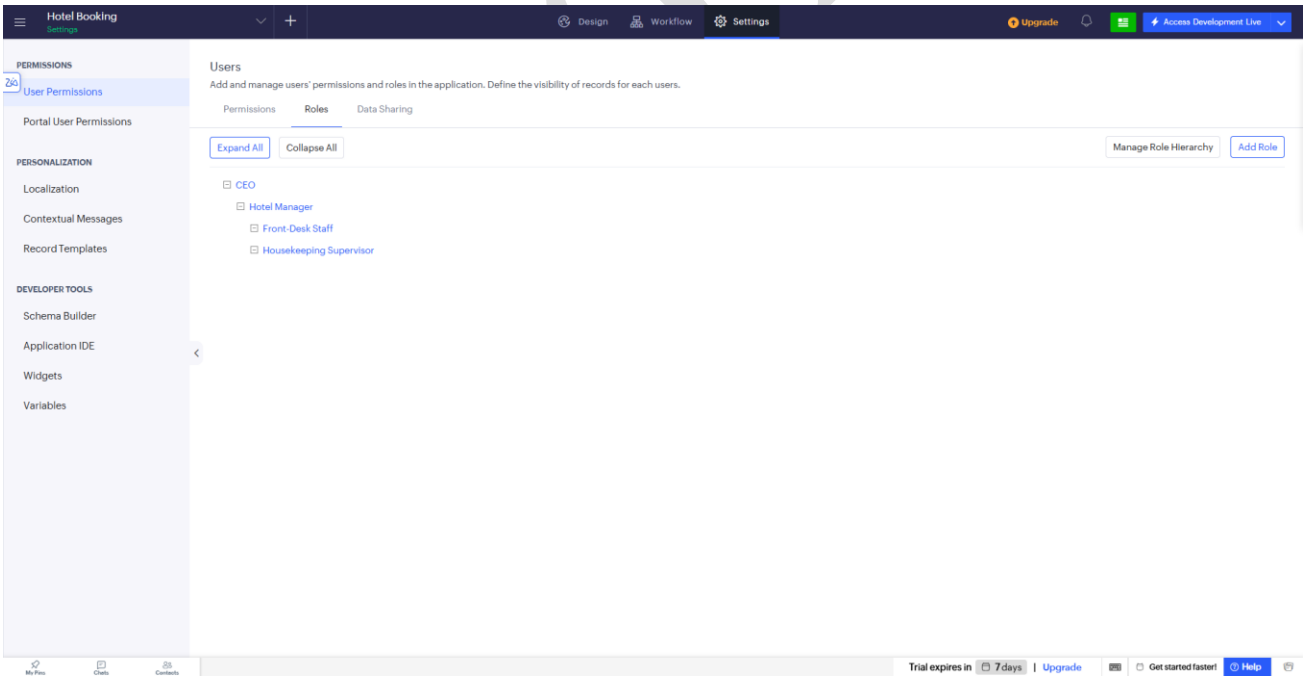


Figure 9: Role Hierarchy Showing CEO, Hotel Manager, Front-Desk Staff and Housekeeping Supervisor

User / Role	Access Observed	Expected as per Table 1
CEO	All forms, reports and the dashboard	Matches
Front-Desk Staff	Booking form and report; no dashboard	Matches
Housekeeping Supervisor	Booking report in read-only mode	Matches

Table 4: Access Observed for Each Role

- **Permission sets:** the predefined Read and Write permissions and the new permission set were available.
- **Roles:** the role hierarchy was displayed with the roles reporting to the CEO.
- **Users:** each user was given a role and a permission set, and the access matched the design.
- **Data sharing:** the rule extended the visibility of booking records to the chosen role at the Read level.

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RESULT

User management and role-based access control were configured in the Hotel Booking application using permission sets, roles, a role hierarchy, users and a data sharing rule. Testing showed that each user could access only the components and records meant for their role, which protects booking data and supports the principle of least privilege.